Against the view of ***Vachaspati Mishra*** that the Absolute (***Brahman***) is the object of ***avidya*** and the limited self its substrate, he held that ***Brahman*** is both the substrate and object of ***avidya***. Oppositions between differentiated subjects, acts and objects of cognition are superimposed upon immutable, self-luminous pure consciousness. So the whole of reality – subjects, objects and experiences – is a gigantic mistake. But it is an error about something, namely, the nature of ultimate reality. Were it otherwise, the conclusion would follow that reality is emptiness (***shunyata***).

Further reading: Bartley 2002; Gerow 1990

**Pralaya** (cosmic retraction): Hindu religious cults understand the cosmos as being emitted from and reabsorbed into an underlying causal substrate. During reabsorption bodies, faculties and basic material elements exist in a potential state. Souls who have not been liberated are also reabsorbed with their accumulated ***karma***-stock, which influences the general conditions of their rebirth.

**Prama** (knowledge or true cognition): to count as a piece of knowledge a cognition must have been produced by a reliable method (***pramana***), and correspond to some reality, whether the object be an aspect of the physical world or something mental (if you are an idealist believing that only thoughts are real). Most philosophers accept that our perceptual and inferential processes are basically reliable and that cognitions can be assumed to be true until they are explicitly contradicted. Truth is manifested in successful activity, but it is not the same as pragmatic success. The stipulation that knowledge yields new information means that a memory does not count as knowledge, although it may be true. A memory is true only if its originating experience was.